Removing saved credentials after a password change

Article KB0010006 | Owner: Service Desk L1 | Subcategory: Account locked | Applies to: Windows 11 23H2/24H2 (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS 14/15 (MacBook Pro/Air), Mobile devices using Exchange/Outlook mail apps, Any device that stores Windows or domain credentials

Summary

After a password change, saved credentials (for example in Windows Credential Manager, mobile mail apps, or mapped network drives) can continue to be used by applications and services, causing repeated authentication failures and eventual account lockout. This article explains how to identify and remove those stale credentials so the account stops locking out and the user can work normally.

Symptoms

- Account locked out message at login or when accessing resources
- Error 0x8007052e: Logon failure: unknown user name or bad password
- Repeated lockout notifications every morning or after a password change
- SSO portal shows account disabled or locked
- Prompt for credentials that immediately fails even after entering the new password

Common causes

- Cached username/password pairs stored in Windows Credential Manager or macOS Keychain
- Saved passwords in mobile mail apps (Outlook, iOS/Android Mail) that still use the old password
- Mapped network drives or printers reconnected with stale credentials
- Service accounts or scheduled tasks configured with the previous password
- Office activation or OneDrive sync tokens that have not been refreshed

Overview

When a user changes their domain password, any application or service that still holds the old credential will attempt to authenticate with the invalid password. Each failed attempt increments the bad-password counter, and after five failures the account is locked for 15 minutes. If the stale credential is used repeatedly (e.g., by a mail app that syncs every few minutes), the account can become locked out repeatedly, leading to frustration and lost productivity. Removing those cached credentials stops the failed logons and allows the lockout timer to expire naturally.

Self-Help: Clear Cached Credentials (continued)

2. **macOS Keychain**
   a. Open **Keychain Access** (Applications -> Utilities).
   b. In the search field, type your username or "ACME".
   c. Locate items such as "Internet password" for outlook.office365.com, "network password" for file shares, or "MicrosoftEnterpriseSSO".
   d. Right-click each item and choose **Delete**, then confirm.
   e. Lock the Keychain again when finished.

3. **Mobile Mail Apps**
   a. Open the Settings app on your iOS/Android device.
   b. Navigate to **Accounts** -> select your ACME Exchange/Office 365 account.
   c. Choose **Delete Account** or **Remove Account** (this only removes the local copy; your mailbox remains intact).
   d. Re-add the account using your **new password** and approve the MFA prompt.

4. **Mapped Network Drives**
   a. Open File Explorer, click **This PC**.
   b. Right-click any mapped drive that shows a red X or prompts for credentials.
   c. Select **Disconnect**. Then re-map the drive using **File Explorer -> Map network drive**, entering your new password when prompted.

5. **Clear Cached Office Tokens**
   a. Open any Office app (Word, Excel, Outlook).
   b. Go to **File -> Account -> Sign out** (if you see your name).
   c. Close the app, then reopen and sign in with your new password.

After completing the above, lock your workstation (Win?+?L) and log back in with the new password. If the account was already locked, wait 15?minutes for the automatic lockout expiry, then try to log in again.

1. 1. **Windows Credential Manager**
   a. Press **Win?+?S**, type "Credential Manager" and open it.
   b. Under **Windows Credentials**, look for entries that contain your username (e.g., ACME\yourID) or generic credentials linked to services like Outlook, OneDrive, or network shares.
   c. Select each suspicious entry and click **Remove**. Confirm the deletion.
   d. Repeat for **Generic Credentials** if you see any that reference ACME resources.

Service Desk Procedure

Agents should verify that the lockout is caused by stale credentials, unlock the account, and guide the user through credential removal. The following steps outline the standard workflow for L1 analysts.

1. 1. **Confirm lockout status**
   a. Ask the user for the exact time of the last lockout and any error messages they saw.
   b. Use the Active Directory Users and Computers console (or the AD self-service tool) to check the user's lockout status and the `badPwdCount` attribute.
   c. If the account is currently locked, note the lockout time; otherwise, proceed to step?2.

2. **Unlock the account**
   a. In ADUC, right-click the user account -> **Properties** -> **Account** tab -> click **Unlock account**.
   b. Alternatively, use the self-service password reset portal to trigger an unlock (if the user knows their new password).
   c. Inform the user that the account is now unlocked and they should wait a minute before attempting to log in.

3. **Identify likely sources of stale credentials**
   a. Ask the user whether they use:
      - Windows laptop/desktop with mapped drives or printers
      - macOS device with Keychain entries
      - Mobile phone/tablet with Outlook or native mail app
      - Any scheduled tasks or service accounts they manage
   b. Based on the answers, prioritize the relevant credential stores.

4. **Guide the user through credential removal**
   a. Walk the user through the self-help steps outlined in the "Self-Help: Clear Cached Credentials" section, adapting instructions to their OS.
   b. For Windows, you may remotely run `cmdkey /list` and `cmdkey /delete:<target>` if the user is comfortable with command line.
   c. For macOS, you can suggest using the `security delete-generic-password -s <service>` command in Terminal if appropriate.
   d. For mobile devices, advise removing and re-adding the Exchange account.

5. **Verify resolution**
   a. After the user has cleared credentials, ask them to lock and unlock their workstation (or reboot the device).
   b. Have them attempt to access a resource that previously triggered the lockout (e.g., open Outlook, access a mapped drive).
   c. Monitor the account for the next 15?minutes; if no further lockout events appear, close the ticket.
   d. If lockouts persist, escalate to the Identity & Access Management (IAM) team for deeper investigation (possible

service account or scheduled task issue).

Verification and Follow-Up

Once the stale credentials have been removed and the account unlocked, confirm that the user can work normally without further lockouts. Document the actions taken and provide the user with a brief reminder to update passwords in all places where they are saved after any future password change.

Escalation

If the account continues to lock out after credential removal and unlock, or if the lockout is traced to a service account, scheduled task, or application that the L1 team cannot modify, escalate to the Identity & Access Management (IAM) group. Include in the escalation: the user's sAMAccountName, timestamps of lockout events, the badPwdCount value, a list of credential stores already checked, and any relevant screenshots or command outputs (e.g., `cmdkey /list`, Event Viewer Security logs showing failed logons).

When to escalate

Escalate to Identity & Access Management (IAM) when lockouts persist after L1 unlock and credential cleanup, or when the root cause is a service account, scheduled task, or third-party application that requires IAM intervention. Provide the user's sAMAccountName, lockout timestamps, badPwdCount, details of credential stores already inspected, and any relevant logs or screenshots.

Keywords: saved credentials, cached password, account lockout, password change, credential manager, keychain, Outlook mail app, mapped drive, locked out, SSO disabled, unlock account, badPwdCount, Identity & Access Management, IAM, Service Desk L1